BRAND GUIDELINES · VERSION 1.0 · SEPTEMBER 2026

BALLINTRA

Let's push things forward.

How Ballintra looks, sounds, and shows up. For founders, collaborators, and anyone who touches the brand.



CONTENTS

Seven chapters, one idea.



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06	Applications	LinkedIn, email, print, social
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Named for a place where things are built to last.

Ballintra is a small village in County Donegal, on the west coast of Ireland, where the Atlantic meets ancient stone. It is where the founder’s family comes from.

The name carries three things into the work: Irish resilience, American ambition, and a plain belief that enduring things are built with care and a clear sense of where you come from.

Some things you carry with you.

Note: the brand tells this story with restraint. No shamrocks, no Celtic knots, no green. The heritage is felt in the standard of the work, not worn as a costume.

Modern Marketing Operations.

A marketing and communications firm built around go-to-market. Marketing, restructured for the moments when the stakes are highest: a raise, a transaction, a launch, a repositioning.

LEADERSHIP

Senior marketing leadership

Owns strategy, storytelling, and outcomes. The person who has done this for 25 years is the person doing the work.

VELOCITY

AI agents

Content, campaigns, targeting, and reporting at machine speed, directed by senior judgment.

CRAFT

Global talent

Vetted specialists from across the world, brought in precisely where the work needs them.

High-impact, highly efficient marketing. Enterprise-grade capability and storytelling without enterprise overhead.

Sophisticated audiences, decisive moments.

Ballintra partners with private equity sponsors, transaction leaders, venture-backed founders, and advocacy initiatives. People who are judged on results, read carefully, and have little patience for noise.

The brand has to work in a data room, a boardroom, and the field. Every asset is built to that standard: clear, credible, and considered.

01 **Senior**
Experience is visible in every choice, and never announced.

02 **Efficient**
High impact from lean inputs. Never described as low cost.

03 **Storytelling-led**
Strategy that is clear enough to be retold by other people.

04 **Human**
Warm, direct, and unhurried. A person, not a process.

Declarative. Human. Unhurried.

We write like a senior operator who has read widely and thinks carefully: short sentences, concrete nouns, a point of view. Warm without being casual. Confident without shouting.

SAY	NOT
Are you shifting fast enough?	~~Leverage our best-in-class solutions.~~
High-impact, highly efficient marketing.	~~Affordable, low-cost marketing.~~
Senior leadership owns the outcome.	~~We help synergize your go-to-market ecosystem.~~
Let’s push things forward.	~~Contact us today to unlock value!~~

Words we use, words we don’t.

USE

- High-impact
- Highly efficient
- Enterprise-grade
- Storytelling
- Senior leadership
- Velocity and craft
- Outcomes
- Moments that decide outcomes

AVOID

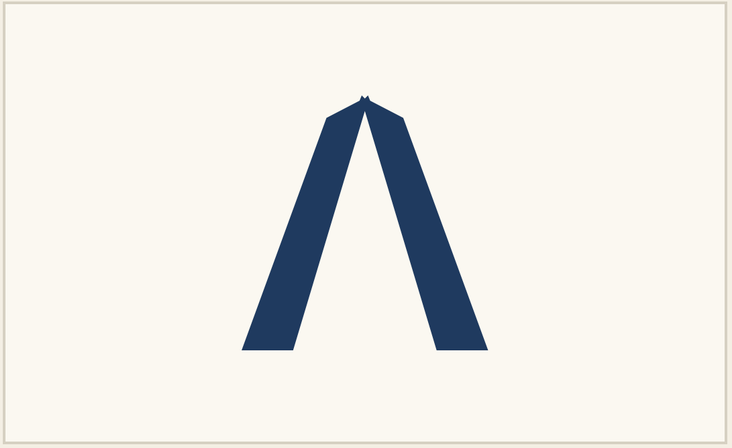
- Low-cost, cheap, discount
- Synergies, ecosystem
- Best-in-class
- Leverage (as a verb)
- Human capital
- Unlock value
- Guru, ninja, rockstar
- Anything that sounds like a prospectus

HOUSE STYLE

- American English throughout.
- No em dashes. Use a period, comma, or colon.
- Emoji: light, and only on social posts. No shamrocks. Ever.
- The tagline is always sentence case with a period: Let’s push things forward.
- Links live in the post body, not the comments.

Three parts, three names.

We use the same words everywhere so the brand is never described two ways. The mark is the peak. The wordmark is the name. The lockup is the two together, with or without the tagline.



Logo mark. The peak. Used alone where the name is already established: avatars, favicons, end cards.

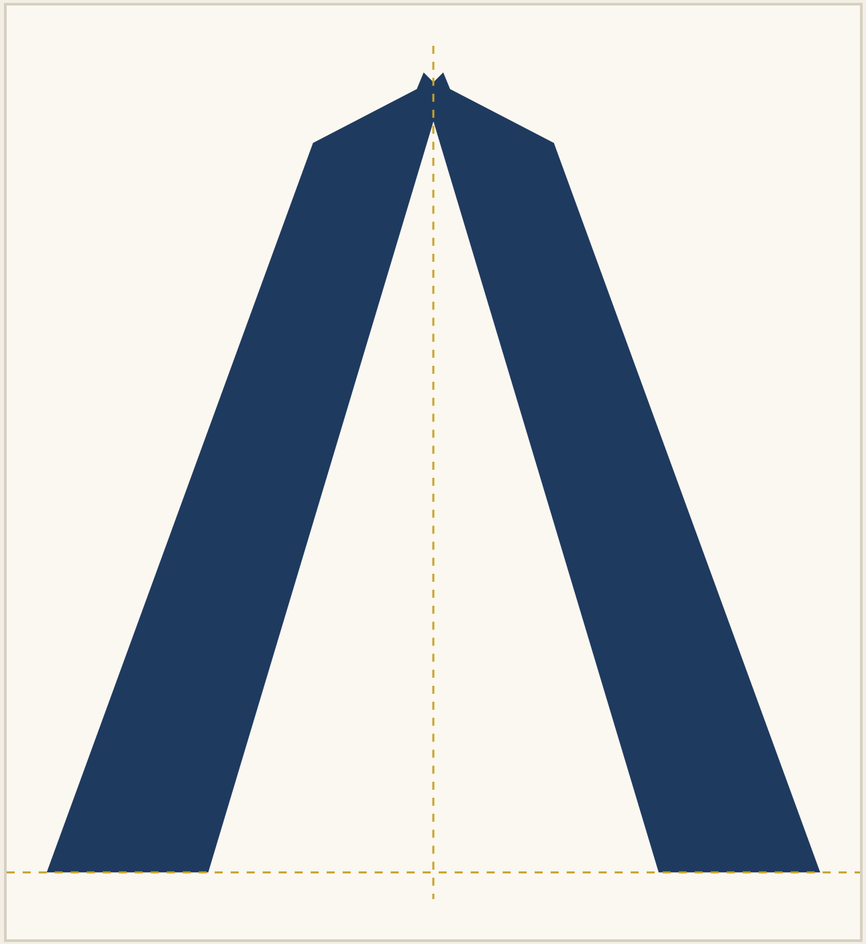


Wordmark. BALLINTRA in Playfair Display capitals, tracked open. Used alone in tight horizontal spaces.



Lockup. Mark, wordmark, and tagline together. The default signature. Stacked or horizontal.

The peak.



A

An ascent

Two strong legs rise to a single point. It reads as a letter A, a summit, and a direction of travel, all at once.

B

Sharp on every edge

The base corners, shoulders, and the small crossed tip stay crisp. The mark is never rounded, softened, or outlined.

C

Symmetrical and grounded

It stands on a flat base and holds its axis. The mark always sits upright, never rotated or tilted.

D

A detail worth keeping

The peak carries a tiny double point. It disappears at small sizes and rewards a closer look at large ones.

Set in Playfair Display, opened up.

BALLINTRA

Capitals only

As a logo or display type, BALLINTRA is always uppercase. Never title case, never lowercase. In running sentences, write Ballintra.

Tracking +109

Letters are spaced open at 0.109 em. Keep the supplied files rather than retyping the name.

Regular weight

No bold, no light, no italic. The italic is reserved for the tagline.

Stacked or horizontal. Always the same parts.



Stacked with tagline. The default for square and vertical formats.



Stacked, no tagline. For small sizes.



Horizontal with tagline. For banners and headers.



Horizontal, no tagline. For signatures and footers.

Use the lockup with tagline when Ballintra is being introduced. Use the version without the tagline when the surrounding copy already carries it, and always when the lockup is under 200 px wide.

Room to breathe.



Clear space

Keep a margin of at least one quarter of the mark's height (X) on every side. Text, edges, and other graphics stay outside it.

Minimum size



Below these sizes, switch to the mark alone or a simpler layout. Never force the tagline small.

Four approved backgrounds.



Navy on Cream. The primary pairing.



Cream on Navy. The premium pairing.



Navy on white, for documents and forms.



Cream over dark photography, with a navy overlay.

Single-color use

For stamps, embossing, and one-color print, use the mark or lockup in solid black or solid navy. Gold is an accent, not a logo color: the mark may appear in gold on navy for special moments, never on cream.



Please don’t.



Don’t stretch or squash.



Don’t rotate or tilt.



Don’t recolor outside the palette.



Don’t soften, blur, or round the corners.



Don’t add shadows, glows, or bevels.



Don’t retype the wordmark in another font or case.



Don’t place on low-contrast backgrounds.



Don’t build your own lockup.

Navy, cream, and a little gold.

PRIMARY

Navy

HEX #1F3A5F
RGB 31 58 95
CMYK 67 39 0 63

Depth, authority, backgrounds, the logo.

PRIMARY

Cream

HEX #F4EFE4
RGB 244 239 228
CMYK 0 2 7 4

The default canvas. Warm, never stark white.

ACCENT

Gold

HEX #C9A227
RGB 201 162 39
CMYK 0 19 81 21

The spark: rules, highlights, taglines on navy.

SUPPORT

Stone

HEX #8A8577
RGB 138 133 119
CMYK 0 4 14 46

Captions, lines, quiet secondary elements.

TEXT

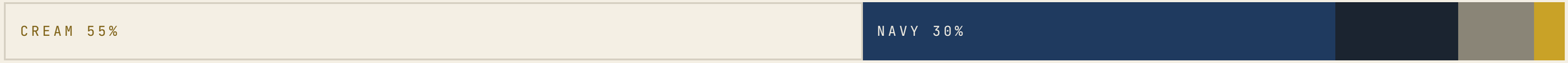
Ink

HEX #1B2430
RGB 27 36 48
CMYK 44 25 0 81

Body copy on cream and white.

CMYK values are starting points for print. Always proof on the chosen stock and adjust to match the on-screen navy and cream.

PROPORTION IN USE



Gold is precious: roughly two percent of any layout. When in doubt, use less.

Pairings that read.

Ratios are computed to WCAG. Gold is bright enough for navy but too pale on cream, so on cream use the deeper gold ink for any small gold text.

BALLINTRA	Navy on Cream	10.01 : 1	AAA	Body, headlines
BALLINTRA	Cream on Navy	10.01 : 1	AAA	Body, headlines
BALLINTRA	Ink on Cream	13.65 : 1	AAA	Long body text
BALLINTRA	Gold on Navy	4.75 : 1	AA	Accents, taglines, large text
BALLINTRA	Gold ink on Cream	5.08 : 1	AA	Small gold text on cream
BALLINTRA	Gold on Cream	2.11 : 1	FAILS	Not for text. Rules only.
BALLINTRA	Muted on Cream	4.91 : 1	AA	Captions
BALLINTRA	Stone on Cream	3.21 : 1	LARGE TEXT ONLY	Decorative only

One serif, one sans, one label.

HEADLINES AND TAGLINE

Aa

Playfair Display

Let's push things forward.

Regular for headlines, italic for the tagline and pull quotes. Free from Google Fonts. Fallback: Georgia.

BODY AND INTERFACE

Aa

Inter

Regular and medium for paragraphs, buttons, and tables.

Free from Google Fonts. Fallback: Arial.

LABELS AND DATA

Aa

JetBrains Mono

EYEBROWS, TAGS, CAPTIONS

Always uppercase with wide tracking, and always small. Fallback: Courier New.

A clear order of reading.

DISPLAY Playfair Display · 96 to 120 px · line 1.05	Marketing, restructured.
HEADLINE Playfair Display · 56 px · line 1.1	Senior leadership owns the outcome.
SUBHEAD Playfair Display · 30 px · line 1.25	Velocity and craft, directed by judgment.
BODY Inter · 20 to 22 px · line 1.55	Ballintra is a marketing and communications firm built around go-to-market.
EYEBROW JetBrains Mono · 14 px · caps · +0.22 em	MARKETING, RESTRUCTURED

One device, used with restraint.

The Ascent is the mark drawn as a family of nested outlines, rising from a shared base. It is the brand’s only pattern: it suggests progress without ever using an arrow or a chart.

Thin gold lines. 1 to 2 px at full size, at 40 to 60 percent opacity.

Off to one side. Anchored to a lower corner or edge and cropped by the frame, never centered.

Behind, not through. It sits behind text and never crosses the reading area.

Navy backgrounds first. On cream, use it very sparingly, in gold ink at low opacity.



Calm, asymmetric, generous.



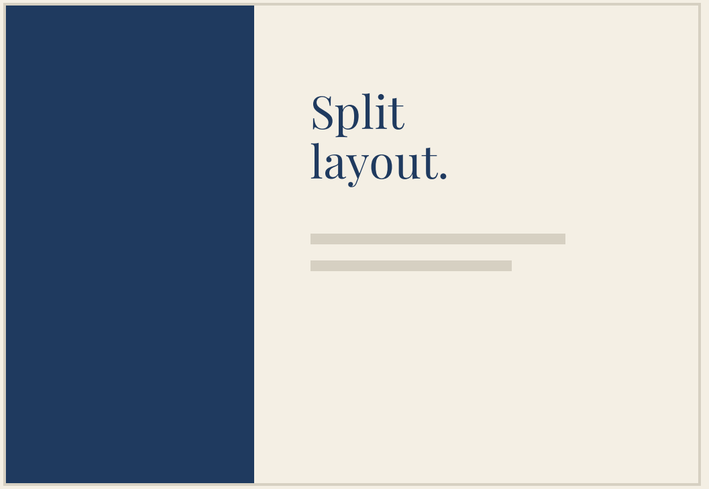
Margins

Generous. At least 5 percent of the shorter side on every edge, more for print.



Alignment

Left-aligned by default. Center only for the lockup and short statements.



Space

Let it do the work. If a layout feels full, remove something before shrinking anything.

Real, quiet, and in motion with purpose.

IMAGERY

Real people, real work, real places. No handshakes, no glowing globes, no stock smiles.

Natural light, muted tones, room around the subject. Photography should sit comfortably next to navy and cream.

Architecture, landscape, and craft details are welcome, and stone, water, and weather suit the story.

Overlay text on photos only over a navy scrim, and keep the logo in cream.

Data visuals use the palette: navy for the main series, gold for the highlight, stone for context.

MOTION

Unhurried. Ease-out curves, 400 to 800 ms, nothing bouncy or spinning.

Build upward. Elements rise into place the way the mark rises to its peak.

Gold is the spark: one accent movement per scene, never several at once.

End on the lockup, held for at least one full second, then cut cleanly.

Square (1:1) is the default format for Ballintra page video. Vertical 4:5 for founder posts.

Company page and founder profile.



Profile banner, 1584 × 396. Text sits right of center so the profile photo never covers it.



Company page banner, 1128 × 191.



Avatar. Mark on navy, centered.



Avatar, cream alternate.



Featured and link thumbnail, 1200 × 627 (1.91:1).

Square for the page, 4:5 for the founder.



Ballintra page post, 1:1.



Page post, news angle, 1:1.



Founder post, 4:5.

Every post carries a tracked link in the body and follows the same rhythm: one clear idea, a short hook, light emoji, then the link. Video ends on the lockup.

Signature, business card, letterhead.

Robert Burke
Founder, Ballintra
Modern Marketing Operations

BALLINTRA

BALLINTRA.COM

Email signature. One horizontal lockup, no images of text, no legal wall above the fold.

BALLINTRA
Let's push things forward.

Robert Burke
FOUNDER

ballintra.com
robert.burke@ballintra.com

Business card, front and back. Print on uncoated cream stock.

BALLINTRA

Let's push things forward.

Letterhead. Lockup top left, generous margins, tagline as the closing signature.

Rules of the road.

Display name is “Ballintra” on every platform. Handle is @ballintra.

Every bio ends on ballintra.com.

Tracked links use lowercase, hyphens, and utm_content set to origin-asset (robert or ballintra).

Never describe the work as low cost. Say high-impact, highly efficient.

Use the supplied files. Never rebuild the mark or retype the wordmark.

What’s in the box.

LOGO-MARK

Navy, cream, gold, and black. SVG and 8x PNG.

WORDMARK

Navy and cream, true outlines. SVG and PNG.

LOCKUP-STACKED

With and without tagline, on cream, on navy, and transparent.

LOCKUP-HORIZONTAL

With and without tagline, on cream, on navy, and transparent.

SOCIAL

Avatars, LinkedIn banners, and the 1200 × 630 sharing image.

FAVICON

512, 180, and 32 px, SVG and PNG.

All logo files are vector outlines with no font dependency. For a website, add the Google Fonts Playfair Display, Inter, and JetBrains Mono. For print, request outlined PDFs from these SVGs.

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